

American Revolution

Before the United States was a country, there were 13 British colonies in America. In 1775, they rose up against the British because they wanted to rule themselves. This type of change in government is called a revolution. The colonies fought many battles with the British. In 1783, peace was made, and the United States of America became an independent country.

American war

The fighting took place along the East Coast of North America. Most of the battles were clustered in the same areas.



The colonists won two battles at Saratoga, gaining them support from the French, Dutch, and Spanish.

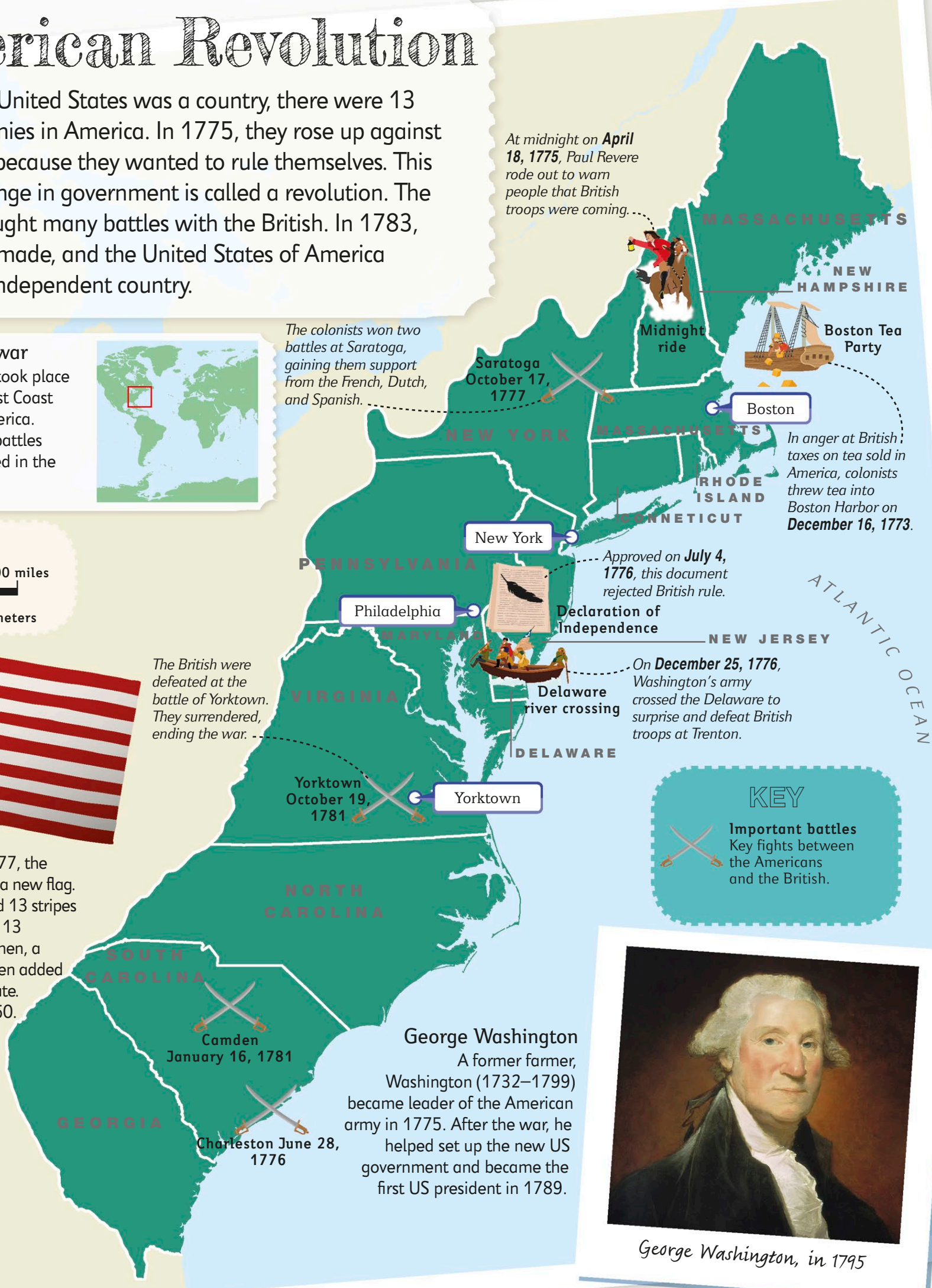
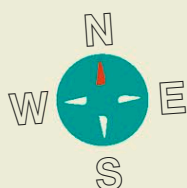
SCALE

0 100 miles
0 100 kilometers



New flag

On June 14, 1777, the Americans flew a new flag. The 13 stars and 13 stripes represented the 13 colonies. Since then, a new star has been added for each new state. There are now 50.



At midnight on **April 18, 1775**, Paul Revere rode out to warn people that British troops were coming.



MASSACHUSETTS

NEW HAMPSHIRE

Midnight ride

Boston Tea Party

Boston

In anger at British taxes on tea sold in America, colonists threw tea into Boston Harbor on **December 16, 1773**.

Saratoga
October 17,
1777

NEW YORK

MASSACHUSETTS

RHODE ISLAND

CONNECTICUT

New York

Approved on **July 4, 1776**, this document rejected British rule.

Declaration of Independence

NEW JERSEY

ATLANTIC OCEAN

The British were defeated at the battle of Yorktown. They surrendered, ending the war.

Yorktown
October 19,
1781

Philadelphia

MARYLAND

VIRGINIA

Delaware river crossing

DELAWARE

Yorktown

NORTH CAROLINA

SOUTH CAROLINA

Camden
January 16, 1781

GEORGIA

Charleston
June 28,
1776

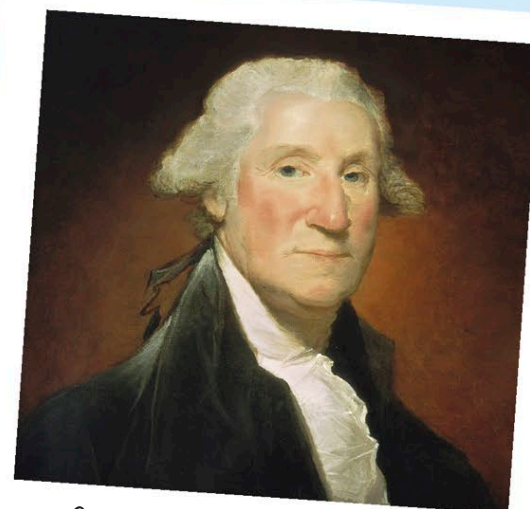
KEY



Important battles
Key fights between the Americans and the British.

George Washington

A former farmer, Washington (1732–1799) became leader of the American army in 1775. After the war, he helped set up the new US government and became the first US president in 1789.



George Washington, in 1795